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31-5-2016

Dryden House
Thornhill Road
South Marston
Swindon
SN3 4RA

Comments on development plan S/OUT/135555

Roads

I agree with the link road from Old Vicarage Lane to Thornhill Road which will reduce traffic movements around Pound corner .I very much disagree with the northern exit road from Rowborough which will encourage rat running along the link road causing a blockage at Keypoint where extra lorries will be joining from the proposed new energy reclaimation centre.
The exit road from Dunelm complex onto Thornhill road will be a great improvement.
Roundabouts give an urban feel and not in keeping with the rural concept we are trying to maintain.

School

The alternative sight for the school is a great improvement. Why were we not allowed even to consider this in the past? It is the ideal place for a school. It will provide a safer option for children going to school by avoiding Pound Corner whilst bringing it nearer to the new development from where the majority of children will come.

The modern design will fit more comfortably with the new development

A much safer environment for the children will be achieved as all their sports and out door activities will be contained on school property, not having to be shared with the public , dogs etc.
It can also be away from disgruntled neighbours and will not have to suffer the noise of building works whilst extending the school .

The Recreation ground will then be returned to its proper use ie recreation for the villagers who own it, the car park will be returned to village use ---- near the church and the centre of the village.

[redacted]

COUNCIL
03 JUN 2016

S|OUT|13|1555 ES

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Headline	Comment
Housing How do you feel about this?	
• 500 dwellings for South Marston (2380 dwellings altogether)	Dislike but inevitable
• The hotel land may become available for housing. If it does should the developers work with the hotel owner and his agents to integrate their plans with this proposal?	Yes definitely
• To make up for the land taken by the relocated school more development land is claimed towards the railway line as illustrated. • The field at the back of Bell Gardens stays available for recreational use.	Good as long as drainage is adequate.
Other?	
Roads How do you feel about this?	
• Contrary to the Local and Neighbourhood Plans there is a link road through the new houses. Potentially this means less traffic on Old Vicarage Lane (OVL), Thornhill Road, Pound Corner reducing noise, pollution and the risk of accident, (especially to school-age children). However, this road, as could existing village roads, be used by Rowborough traffic to cut-through South Marston to the Key Point exit during the morning and evening rush hours and during times of heavy congestion on the A420.	Even more so if 2nd exit from Rowborough is allowed. The exit route should be from Southern road only into A420 + road under railway built as second exit road.
• Only one vehicular access to the village centre is shown on the illustration.	
• The tunnel from Rowborough remains uncertain.	This is necessary – see above
• There are two roads for Rowborough off OVL which is contrary to previous requests to have no direct road access. Will South Marston be used as a rat run for Rowborough traffic? Will these roads be used as an excuse by developers to avoid building the tunnel at Rowborough?	YES
• The new link road with the 2 roundabouts on the map look to be much bigger than the roads that already exist in the village.	Roundabouts also imply urbanisation not "rural feel"
• Will there be congestion at Key Point? • There is a proposed additional warehouse and a re-newable energy plant at Key Point.	Can't see how it can be avoided as plans stand
Other?	
Flooding	
• There are proposals for managing flooding. Will they protect those areas already vulnerable and against events such as in the 2007. **What are your thoughts?**	Present ideas are optimistic!
Other? Land between hotel & railway always v. wet. Drainage needs to be extensive & adequate.	

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School on the 'Alternative Plan for South Marston' How do you feel about this?	
The Alternative **one-form entry** Primary School is smaller than shown in the Local and Neighbourhood Plans. • The existing school is to expand to **three** times its current capacity (45 children per year group x 6 year groups + pre-school……approx. 300 children.) • The alternative one-form entry school is **twice** the size of the existing school. (30 children per year group x 6 year groups + pre-school……approx. 210 children.)	Will discourage outsiders thereby reducing traffic movements
• The new link road that serves the relocated school has no blind bends or pinch-points according to the illustration.	✓
• The school can be reached by the footpaths/ bridleways /cycle networks as well as by car via the new link road. • Pupils, parents and staff may be encouraged to walk/ride to school because of the reduced traffic due to lower pupil numbers and potentially less traffic on existing village roads.	Safer for all.
• The proposed modern design for the new village school will fit more appropriately alongside the new houses. The existing character-filled village centre will retain its rural, historic feel.	This is the best location. Self contained & away from neighbours.
The relocated school according to the illustration has: • Its own sports field • Potentially a boundary creating an enclosed area for outside activities • Is in easy reach of open spaces and woodland.	Will release Rec. & be safer all round for pupils.
• There will be no disruption to the pupils' learning during the build. Relocation after completion.	Agree
Other?	

The REC (with School on the 'Alternative Plan for South Marston') What is your opinion?	
• A possible reduction in traffic on OVL and Thornhill potentially could make it safer for residents wanting to walk or cycle to and from The REC. • There will be ample parking for church, etc.	Agreed.
• The REC, without the school expansion remains intact.	Agree
• Retention of the land at the back of Bell Gardens extends the current Rec for more sporting and community activities (inc potential income),	Agree
• Potentially the existing school building can be utilised by the community. Any extension/amendment to the building can be designed to embrace the original Victorian school.	Much better use can be made of this site & Victorian building incorporated into better design.
• If the hotel closes, facilities for gym, squash, swimming, etc are much valued and need to be provided elsewhere.	
Other?	

Signature [redacted] Name Mrs M. Cooper.

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Date 3-6-2016